- Is technical innovation being deployed regardless of its ecological impacts?
- Is it efnough to develop new environmentally sensitive technologies under current economic incentives, or does there need to be a shift in the fundamental assumptions underpinning economic behavior (for example, do we really want products or simply the services that products provide)?
- Can technology be used as a means for reducing rates of consumption while still providing for people's needs?
- Can we fulfill our obligations to future generations by simply substituting technological capital for rapidly disappearing natural capital?

To the extent the major **tribal societies** of the world are concerned they have been always critical to the new tools and techniques of promoting growth and development. But their views were generally considered as the opinions of uneducated and 'savage minds'.[17] Right from Australian Aborigines to the Bhils and Santhals of India, almost all of them, objected even to the construction of metallised roads running through their habitat 'modern factories and the townships'. Today we see the same people getting support from the non-tribal population against the proposals of the *Poscos* and *Vedantas* in India. Just the colours of the people's movement have changed but the basic question remain the same – Will the local habitat and the ecosystem sustain the fallouts of these developments? The government is innovating a new idea to fight such agitations by proposing a share for the 'local community' in the profit of the industrial units to be set up there! Will it make the industrial practices 'ecologically sustainable'? We don't have the answers, again!

The above-given questions are not easy to answer. However, it is clear, that the value structures and ethical frameworks of modernity will determine whether technological innovation is used for the protection or destruction of natural ecosystems. Technology has at once been the source of many environmental problems, but also a means for safeguarding environmental quality.[18] The emergence of concepts such as *'green engineering'* or *'green design'*, reflects the underlying confidence of many observers that